Background of the problem statement:

The company had created a new website for the LiveDocApp where it's patient can add their details on the website. The company wanted to use a public cloud for the internet facing website of LiveDocApp. Once the website was deployed, patients started complaining that the pages are not loading fast enough. We realized that the website gets global traffic and the static assets like pages are served from a single server. We had to make sure that the traffic coming to the application from different parts of the world is load balanced at the DNS level.

I used AWS platform to design the solution using IaaS and or PaaS.

Below was my suggested solution

To enable the company to safely adopt cloud technology while maintaining security, scalability, and global performance, the following AWS-based architecture was deployed. This solution focused on static content delivery, secure backend compute, automatic scaling, and low-latency global access.

Static Live-Doc Landing Page (S3 with CloudFront)

A static Livedoc landing page was forwarded to me and deployed into an Amazon S3 bucket configured for static website hosting. This bucket was used strictly for public content accessible via CloudFront, like the company's home page. Also, it had to support public read access.

Another s3 bucket, strictly private for storing team folders like production and test and other internal documents its access was to be controlled via IAM and bucket policies and it was not exposed to the internet

To ensure global low latency, Amazon CloudFront was then configured with the static web hosting S3 bucket as its origin, allowing cached copies to be delivered from edge locations worldwide. This was to improve performance and offload traffic from the backend infrastructure.

EC2 Instance with IAM Role - Backend Server

An Amazon EC2 instance was created to support backend tasks. An IAM role was attached to the instance to grant secure access to S3. This ensured: Security, Least-privilege access to the teammate-storage bucket.

Auto Scaling Group + Classic Load Balancer

To handle increasing and variable traffic load, an Auto Scaling Group (ASG) was created with multiple EC2 instances- min 2 and max 5

A Classic Load Balancer was deployed as an internet-facing entry point, responsible for: distributing traffic evenly, improving availability, monitoring instance health, ensuring no EC2 instance is directly exposed to the internet. So, it provided an abstraction layer, improved security and allowed EC2 instances to scale in/out without disrupting frontend access.

CloudFront CDN for Global Low Latency

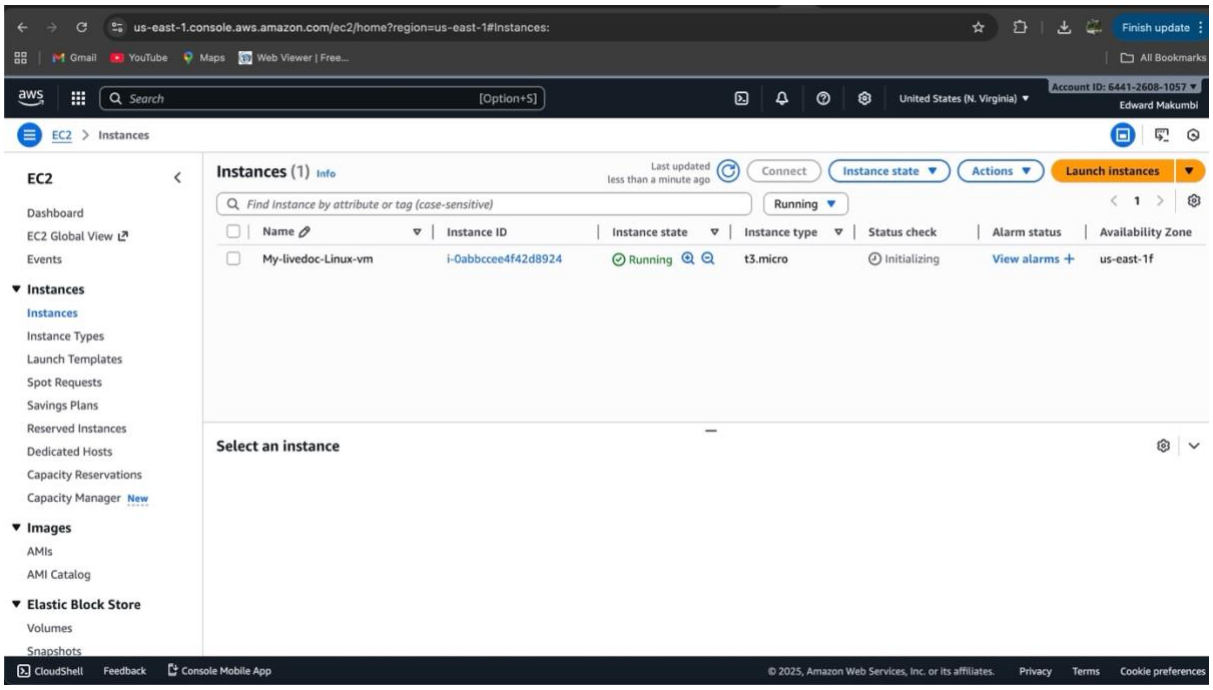
To improve global performance further, CloudFront was added as a Content Delivery Network (CDN) for the static S3-hosted website. It was to help with, very low latency for international users (those outside US east AZs), edge caching to reduce S3 load, and better global user experience.

NOTE - Route 53

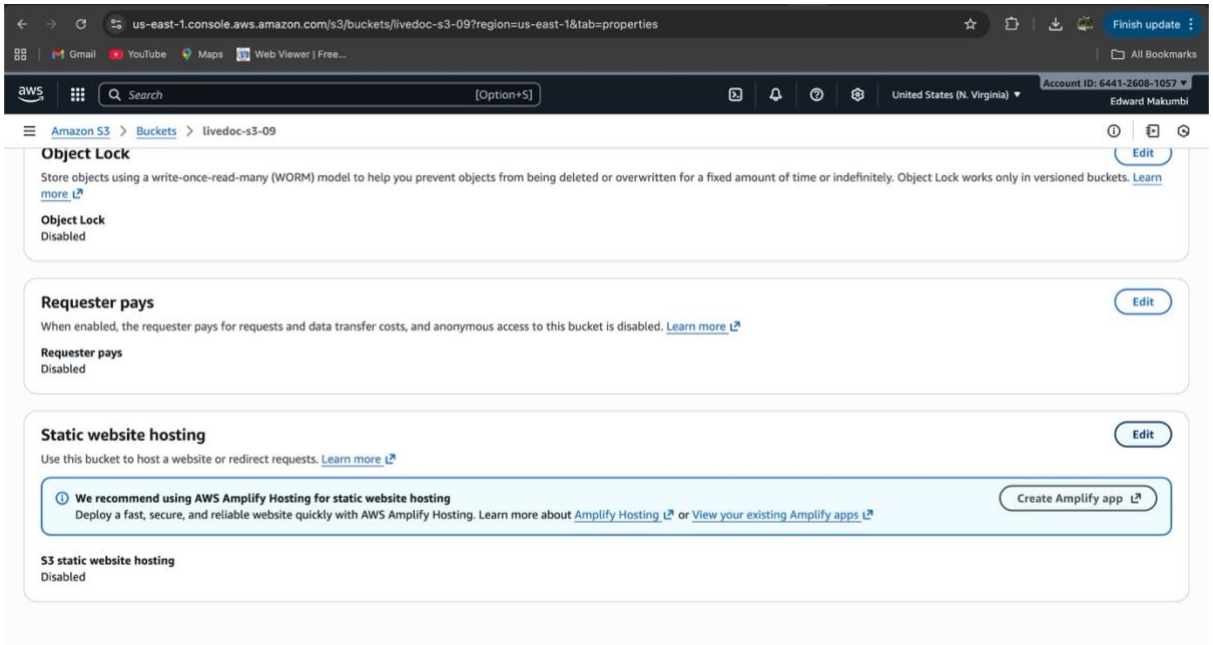
I wasn't able to use Route 53 effectively as the new domain wasn't bought yet and so I couldn't create DNS records, and map CloudFront to a custom URL.

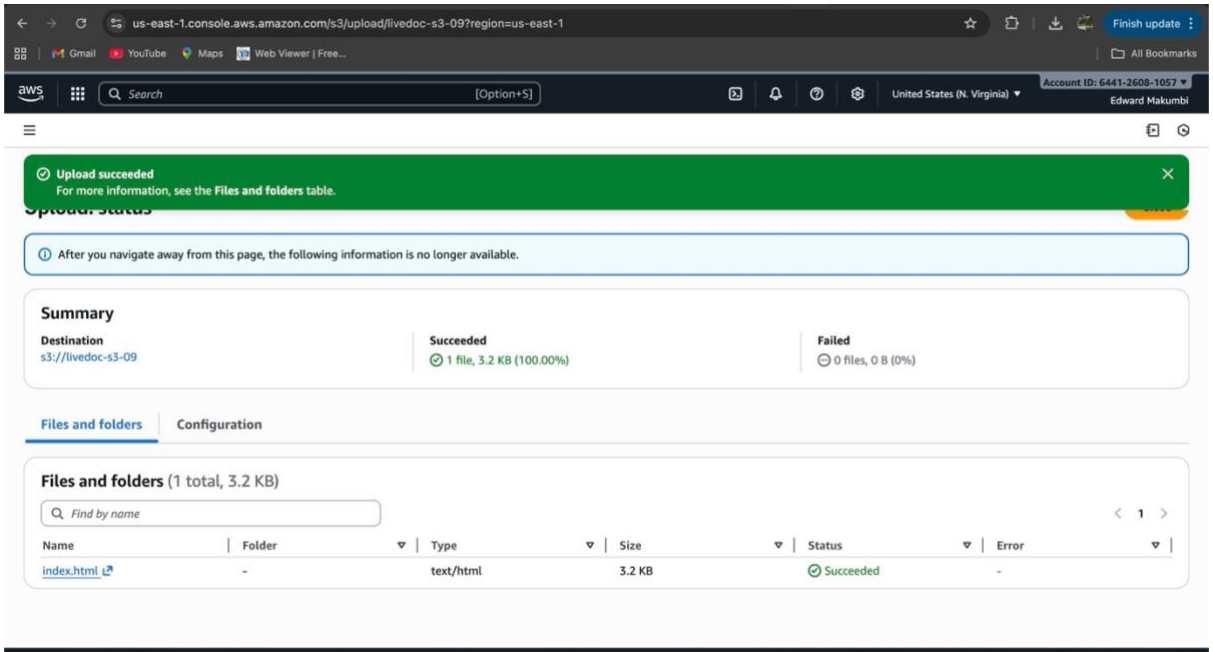
<u>Screenshots</u>

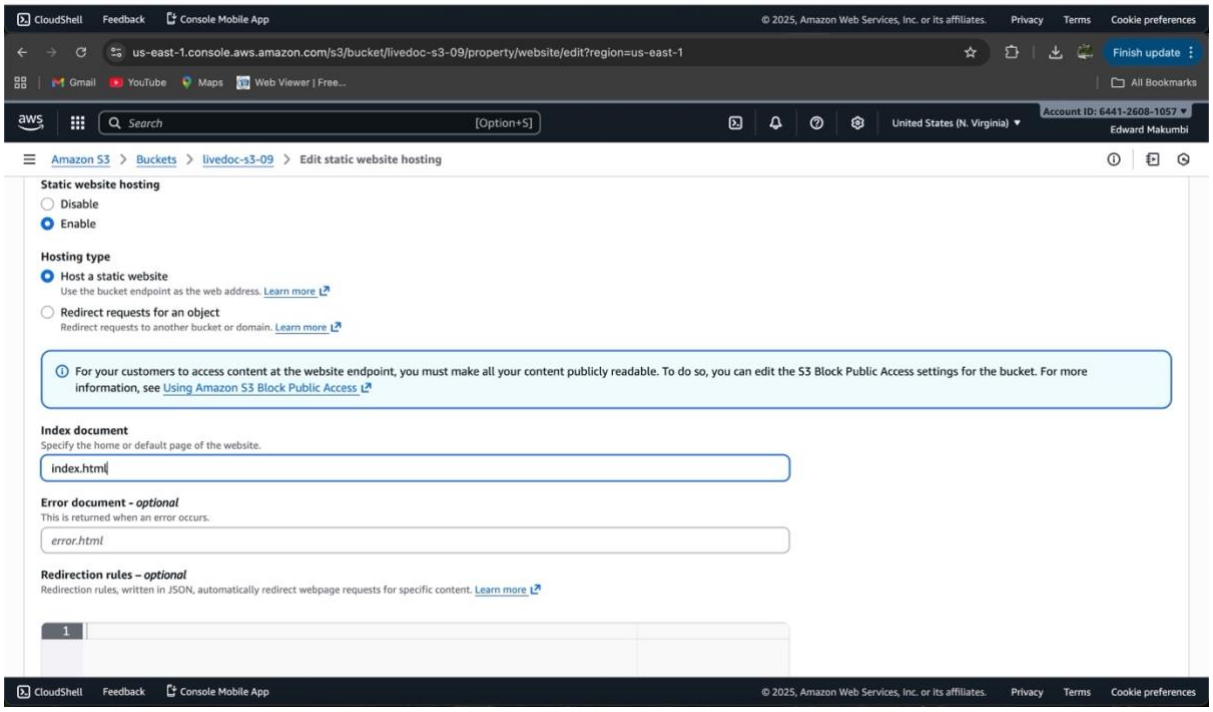
Linux EC2 created – my-Livedoc-Linux in us east



Amazon S3 bucket configured for static website hosting


us-east-1.console.aws.amazon.com/s3/buckets/livedoc-s3-09?region=us-east-1&tab=properties
Finish update
Gmail
YouTube
Maps
Web Viewer | Free...
All Bookmarks
aws
Search
[Option+S]
United States (N. Virginia)
Account ID: 6441-2608-1057
Edward Makumbi
Amazon S3 > Buckets > livedoc-s3-09
Object Lock
Edit
Store objects using a write-once-read-many (WORM) model to help you prevent objects from being deleted or overwritten for a fixed amount of time or indefinitely. Object Lock works only in versioned buckets. Learn more
Object Lock
Disabled
Requester pays
Edit
When enabled, the requester pays for requests and data transfer costs, and anonymous access to this bucket is disabled. Learn more
Requester pays
Disabled
Static website hosting
Edit
Use this bucket to host a website or redirect requests. Learn more
We recommend using AWS Amplify Hosting for static website hosting
Deploy a fast, secure, and reliable website quickly with AWS Amplify Hosting. Learn more about Amplify Hosting or View your existing Amplify apps
Create Amplify app
S3 static website hosting
Disabled





Connecting into an amazon EC2 instance which was to support backend tasks, a web server was installed to guarantee it's running on port 80 and for the load balancer to mark it as in-service in the health checks.

us-east-1.console.aws.amazon.com/ec2-instance-connect/ssh/home?addressFamily=ipv4&connType=standard&instanceId=i-0abbccee4f42d8924&o...

Finish update

Gmail YouTube Maps Web Viewer | Free... All Bookmarks

aws Search [Option+S] United States (N. Virginia) Account ID: 6441-2608-1057 Edward Makumbi

```
  ,     #_
  ~\_  ####_        Amazon Linux 2023
 ~~  \_#####\
 ~~     \###|
 ~~       \#/ ___   https://aws.amazon.com/linux/amazon-linux-2023
  ~~       V~' '->
   ~~~         /
     ~~._.   _/
        _/ _/
      _/m/'
[ec2-user@ip-172-31-72-95 ~]$ sudo su
[root@ip-172-31-72-95 ec2-user]# yum install -y httpd
Amazon Linux 2023 Kernel Livepatch repository                                    250 kB/s |  29 kB     00:00
Last metadata expiration check: 0:00:01 ago on Tue Dec  9 18:01:55 2025.
Dependencies resolved.
================================================================================================================
 Package                    Architecture        Version                        Repository                  Size
================================================================================================================
Installing:
 httpd                      x86_64              2.4.65-1.amzn2023.0.2          amazonlinux                 47 k
Installing dependencies:
 apr                        x86_64              1.7.5-1.amzn2023.0.4           amazonlinux                129 k
 apr-util                   x86_64              1.6.3-1.amzn2023.0.2           amazonlinux                 97 k
 apr-util-lmdb              x86_64              1.6.3-1.amzn2023.0.2           amazonlinux                 13 k
 generic-logos-httpd        noarch              18.0.0-12.amzn2023.0.3         amazonlinux                 19 k
 httpd-core                 x86_64              2.4.65-1.amzn2023.0.2          amazonlinux                1.4 M
 httpd-filesystem           noarch              2.4.65-1.amzn2023.0.2          amazonlinux                 13 k
 httpd-tools                x86_64              2.4.65-1.amzn2023.0.2          amazonlinux                 81 k
 libbrotli                  x86_64              1.0.9-4.amzn2023.0.2           amazonlinux                315 k
 mailcap                    noarch              2.1.49-3.amzn2023.0.3          amazonlinux                 33 k
```

i-0abbccee4f42d8924 (My-livedoc-Linux-vm)

PublicIPs: 18.207.251.226 PrivateIPs: 172.31.72.95

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us-east-1.console.aws.amazon.com/ec2-instance-connect/ssh/home?addressFamily=ipv4&connType=standard&instanceId=i-0abbccee4f42d8924&o...

Finish update

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aws Search [Option+S] United States (N. Virginia) Account ID: 6441-2608-1057 Edward Makumbi

```
  mod_lua-2.4.65-1.amzn2023.0.2.x86_64

Complete!
[root@ip-172-31-72-95 ec2-user]# systemctl start httpd
[root@ip-172-31-72-95 ec2-user]# service httpd status
Redirecting to /bin/systemctl status httpd.service
● httpd.service - The Apache HTTP Server
     Loaded: loaded (/usr/lib/systemd/system/httpd.service; disabled; preset: disabled)
     Active: active (running) since Tue 2025-12-09 18:03:11 UTC; 26s ago
       Docs: man:httpd.service(8)
   Main PID: 25954 (httpd)
     Status: "Total requests: 0; Idle/Busy workers 100/0;Requests/sec: 0; Bytes served/sec:   0 B/sec"
      Tasks: 177 (limit: 1067)
     Memory: 13.3M
        CPU: 90ms
     CGroup: /system.slice/httpd.service
             ├─25954 /usr/sbin/httpd -DFOREGROUND
             ├─25955 /usr/sbin/httpd -DFOREGROUND
             ├─25956 /usr/sbin/httpd -DFOREGROUND
             ├─25957 /usr/sbin/httpd -DFOREGROUND
             └─25958 /usr/sbin/httpd -DFOREGROUND

Dec 09 18:03:11 ip-172-31-72-95.ec2.internal systemd[1]: Starting httpd.service - The Apache HTTP Server...
Dec 09 18:03:11 ip-172-31-72-95.ec2.internal systemd[1]: Started httpd.service - The Apache HTTP Server.
Dec 09 18:03:11 ip-172-31-72-95.ec2.internal httpd[25954]: Server configured, listening on: port 80
[root@ip-172-31-72-95 ec2-user]# cd /var/www/html/
[root@ip-172-31-72-95 html]# ll
total 0
[root@ip-172-31-72-95 html]# vi index.html
[root@ip-172-31-72-95 html]# cat index.html
```

i-0abbccee4f42d8924 (My-livedoc-Linux-vm)

PublicIPs: 18.207.251.226 PrivateIPs: 172.31.72.95

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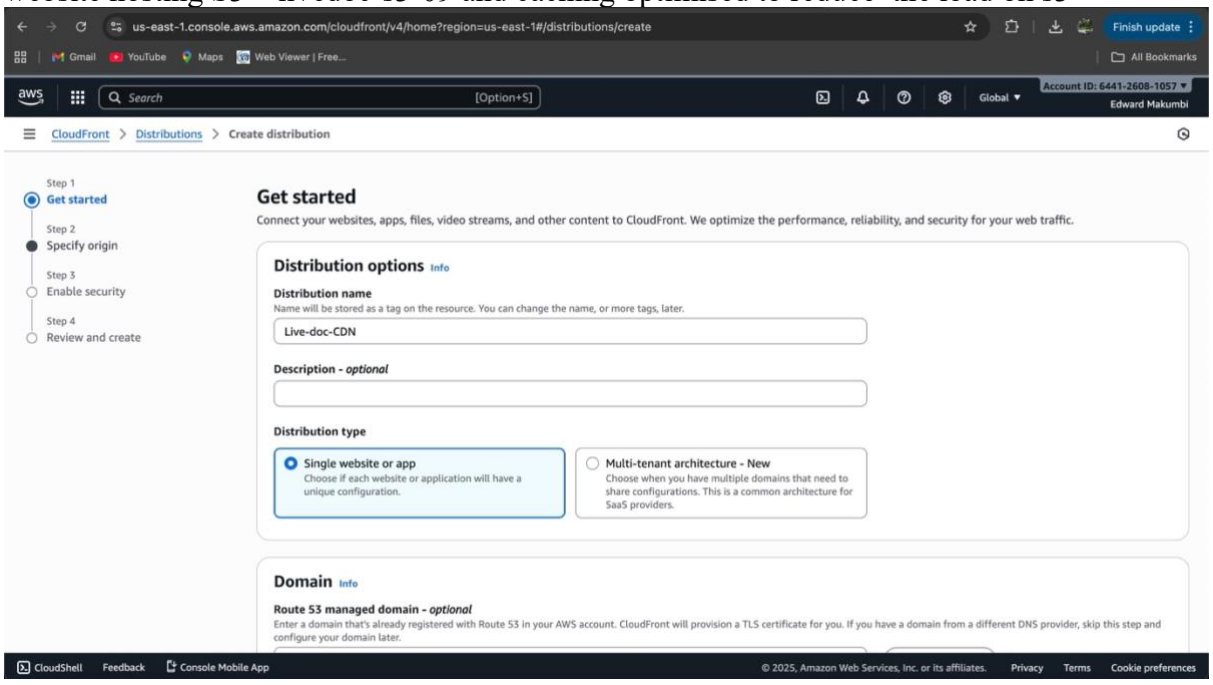
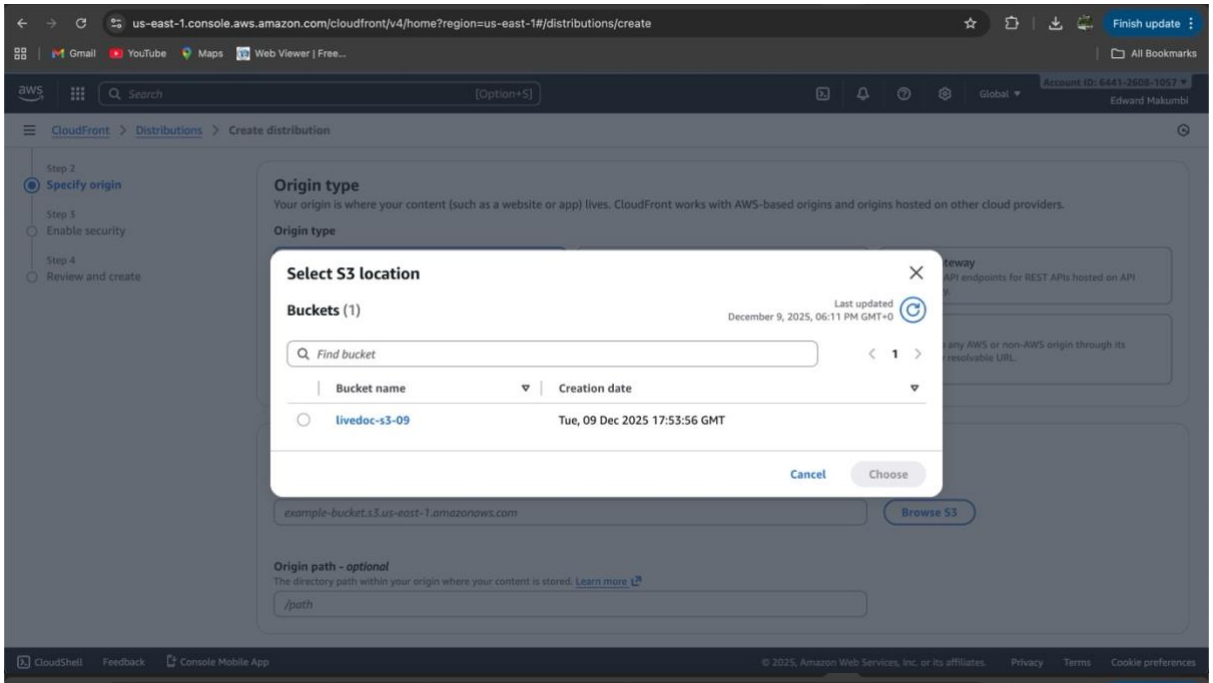
```
[root@ip-172-31-72-95 html]# vi index.html
[root@ip-172-31-72-95 html]# cat index.html
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
<head>
    <meta charset="UTF-8" />
    <meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0" />
    <title>LiveDoc | Your Digital Health Companion</title>

    <style>
        body {
            margin: 0;
            font-family: Arial, Helvetica, sans-serif;
            background: #f9fbfd;
            color: #333;
        }

        /* Header */
        .header {
            background: #0F62FE;
            color: white;
            padding: 20px 40px;
            text-align: center;
        }

        .header h1 {
            margin: 0;
            font-size: 2.4rem;
            font-weight: 700;
        }
```

i-0abbccee4f42d8924 (My-livedoc-Linux-vm)

PublicIPs: 18.207.251.226 PrivateIPs: 172.31.72.95

To improve global performance further, CloudFront was added with origin type as the static website hosting S3 – livedoc-s3-09 and caching optimised to reduce the load on s3




us-east-1.console.aws.amazon.com/cloudfront/v4/home?region=us-east-1#/distributions/create
Finish update
Gmail
YouTube
Maps
Web Viewer | Free...
All Bookmarks
Search
[Option+5]
Global
Account ID: 6441-2608-1057
Edward Makumbi
CloudFront > Distributions > Create distribution
Step 2
Specify origin
Step 3
Enable security
Step 4
Review and create
Origin type
Your origin is where your content (such as a website or app) lives. CloudFront works with AWS-based origins and origins hosted on other cloud providers.
Origin type
Select S3 location
Buckets (1)
Last updated
December 9, 2025, 06:11 PM GMT+0
Find bucket
Bucket name
Creation date
livedoc-s3-09
Tue, 09 Dec 2025 17:53:56 GMT
Cancel
Choose
example-bucket.s3.us-east-1.amazonaws.com
Browse S3
Origin path - optional
The directory path within your origin where your content is stored. Learn more
/path
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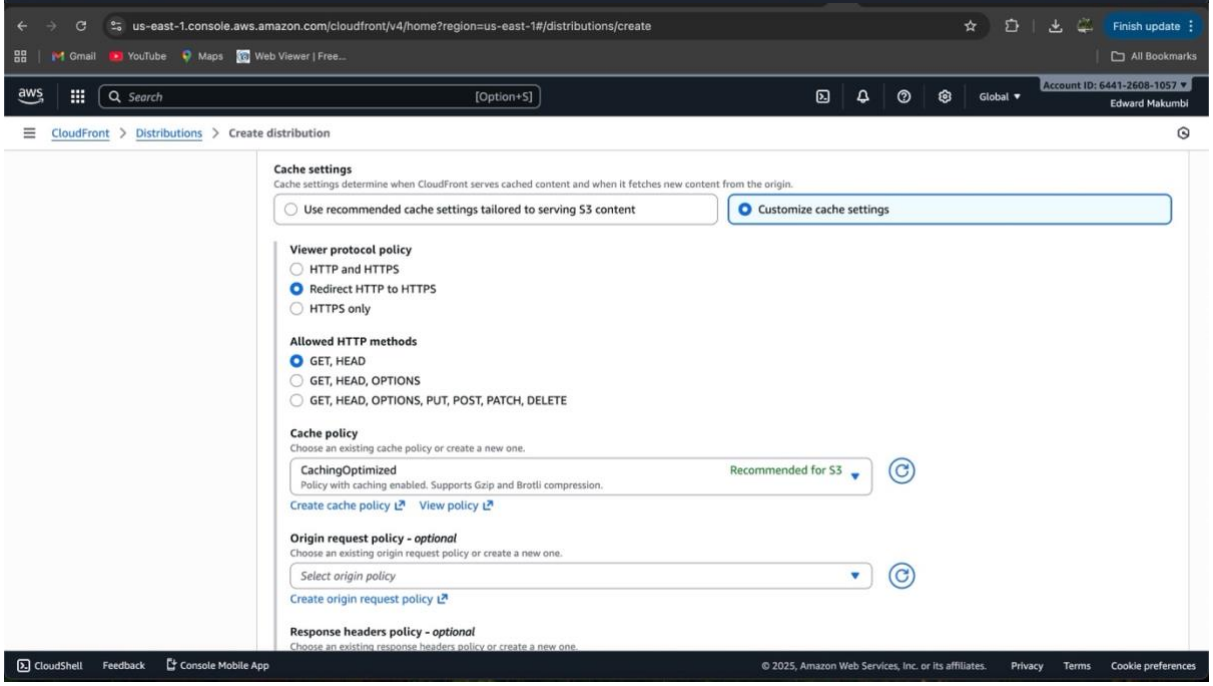
us-east-1.console.aws.amazon.com/cloudfront/v4/home?region=us-east-1#/distributions/create
Finish update
Gmail
YouTube
Maps
Web Viewer | Free...
All Bookmarks
Search
[Option+5]
Global
Account ID: 6441-2608-1057
Edward Makumbi
CloudFront > Distributions > Create distribution
Cache settings
Cache settings determine when CloudFront serves cached content and when it fetches new content from the origin.
Use recommended cache settings tailored to serving S3 content
Customize cache settings
Viewer protocol policy
HTTP and HTTPS
Redirect HTTP to HTTPS
HTTPS only
Allowed HTTP methods
GET, HEAD
GET, HEAD, OPTIONS
GET, HEAD, OPTIONS, PUT, POST, PATCH, DELETE
Cache policy
Choose an existing cache policy or create a new one.
CachingOptimized
Recommended for S3
Policy with caching enabled. Supports Gzip and Brotli compression.
Create cache policy
View policy
Origin request policy - optional
Choose an existing origin request policy or create a new one.
Select origin policy
Create origin request policy
Response headers policy - optional
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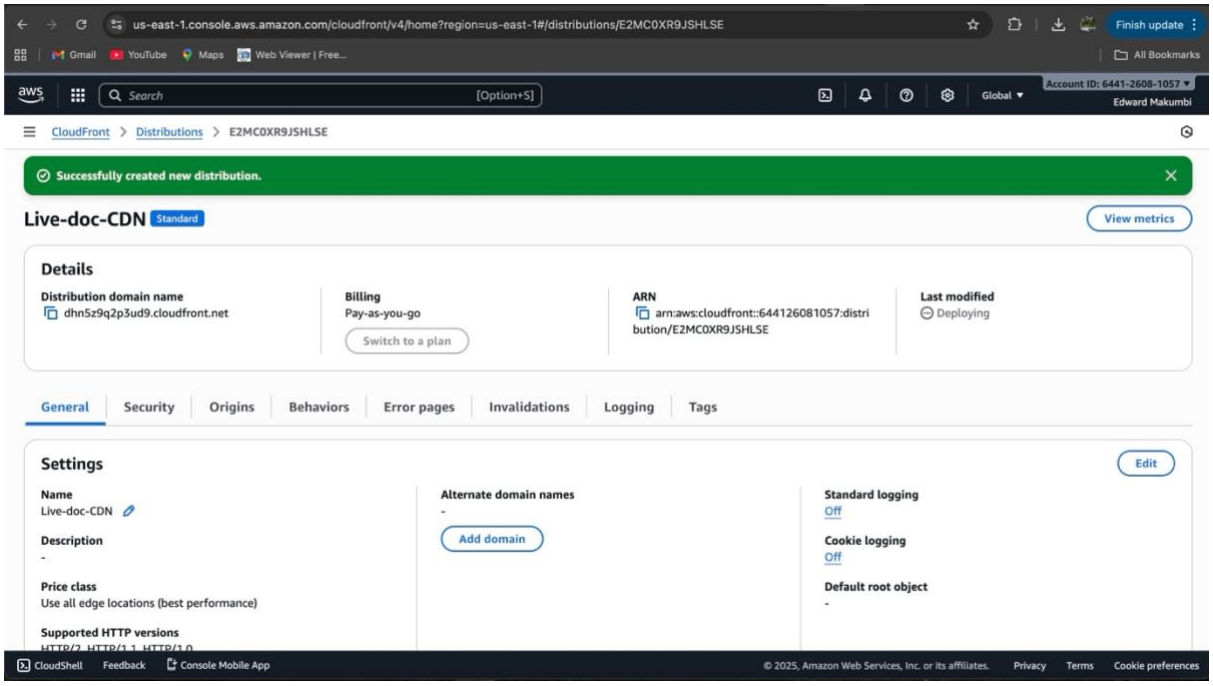
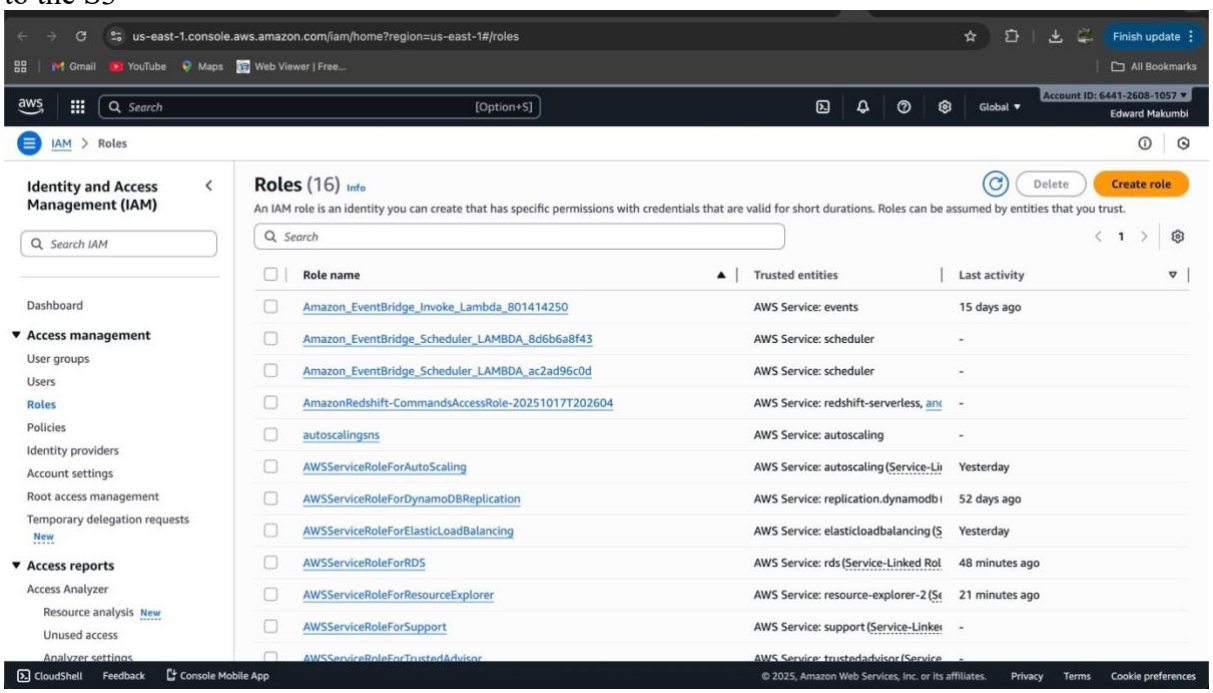


Full s3 access IAM role is assigned to my-Livedoc-Linux EC2, this garantees secure access to the S3



us-east-1.console.aws.amazon.com/iam/home?region=us-east-1#/roles/create

Finish update

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aws Search [Option+S] Global Account ID: 6441-2608-1057 Edward Makumbi

IAM > Roles > Create role

Step 1
Select trusted entity

Step 2
Add permissions

Step 3
Name, review, and create

Select trusted entity Info

Trusted entity type

- AWS service — Allow AWS services like EC2, Lambda, or others to perform actions in this account.
- AWS account — Allow entities in other AWS accounts belonging to you or a 3rd party to perform actions in this account.
- Web identity — Allows users federated by the specified external web identity provider to assume this role to perform actions in this account.
- SAML 2.0 federation — Allow users federated with SAML 2.0 from a corporate directory to perform actions in this account.
- Custom trust policy — Create a custom trust policy to enable others to perform actions in this account.

Use case

Allow an AWS service like EC2, Lambda, or others to perform actions in this account.

Service or use case

EC2

Choose a use case for the specified service.

Use case

- EC2 — Allows EC2 instances to call AWS services on your behalf.
- EC2 Role for AWS Systems Manager

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us-east-1.console.aws.amazon.com/iam/home?region=us-east-1#/roles/create?trustedEntityType=AWS_SERVICE&selectedService=EC2&selectedUse...

Finish update

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aws Search [Option+S] Global Account ID: 6441-2608-1057 Edward Makumbi

IAM > Roles > Create role

Step 1
Select trusted entity

Step 2
Add permissions

Step 3
Name, review, and create

Add permissions Info

Permissions policies (1/1112) Info

Choose one or more policies to attach to your new role.

Filter by Type

s3 | All types | 14 matches | 1

Policy name	Type	Description
AmazonDMSRedshiftS3Role	AWS managed	Provides access to manage S3 settings...
AmazonS3FullAccess	AWS managed	Provides full access to all buckets via t...
AmazonS3ObjectLambdaExecutionRoleP...	AWS managed	Provides AWS Lambda functions permi...
AmazonS3OutpostsFullAccess	AWS managed	Provides full access to Amazon S3 on ...
AmazonS3OutpostsReadOnlyAccess	AWS managed	Provides read only access to Amazon S...
AmazonS3ReadOnlyAccess	AWS managed	Provides read only access to all bucket...
AmazonS3TablesFullAccess	AWS managed	Provides full access to all S3 table buc...
AmazonS3TablesLakeFormationServiceR...	AWS managed	This managed policy grants AWS Lake ...
AmazonS3TablesReadOnlyAccess	AWS managed	Provides read only access to all S3 tabl...

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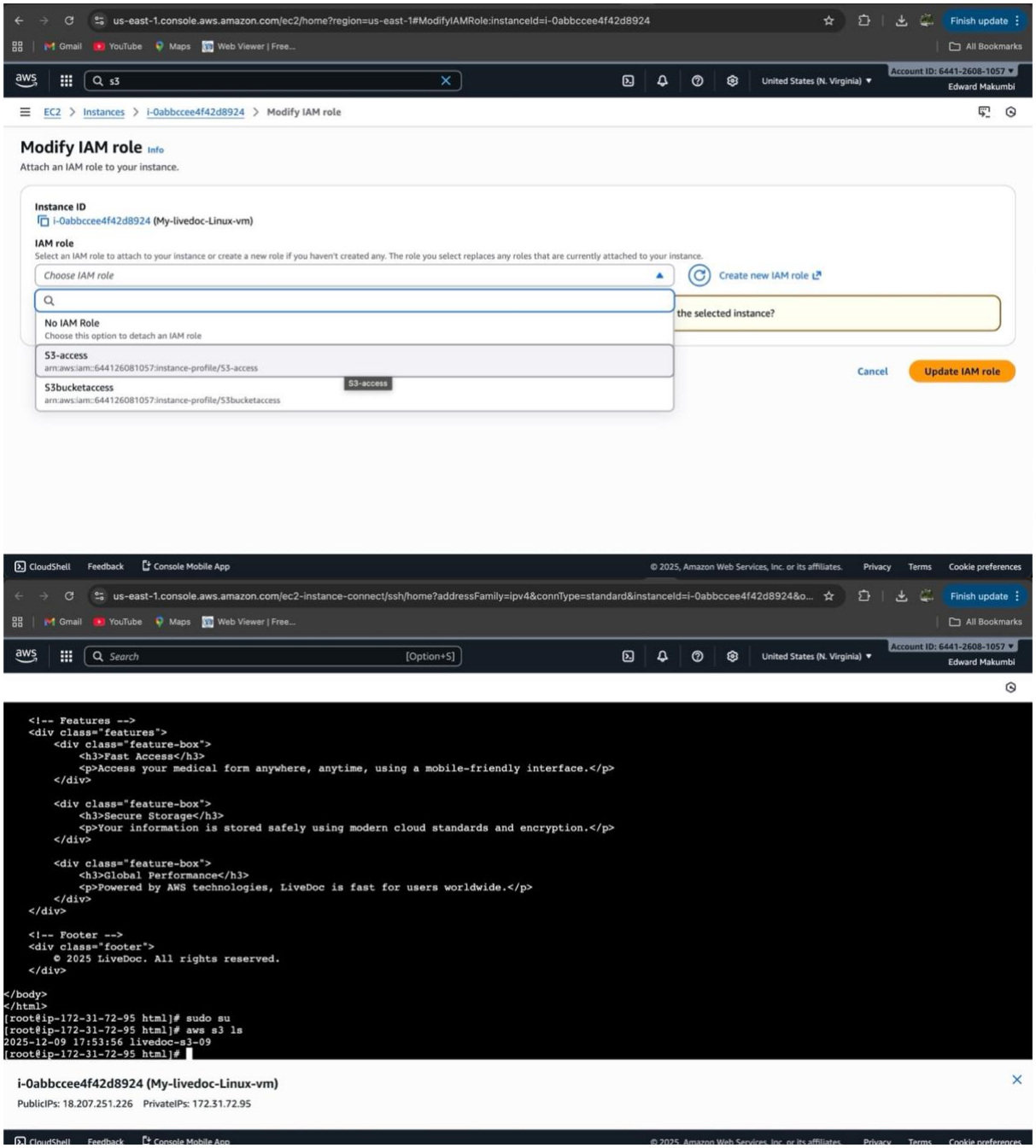

Private s3 for the team created and folders added

us-east-1.console.aws.amazon.com/s3/bucket/create?region=us-east-1

Finish update

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aws cloudformation United States (N. Virginia) Account ID: 6441-2608-1057 Edward Makumbi

Amazon S3 > Buckets > Create bucket

Bucket name Info

live-doc-for-team

Bucket names must be 3 to 63 characters and unique within the global namespace. Bucket names must also begin and end with a letter or number. Valid characters are a-z, 0-9, periods (.), and hyphens (-). Learn more

Copy settings from existing bucket - *optional*

Only the bucket settings in the following configuration are copied.

Choose bucket

Format: s3://bucket/prefix

Object Ownership Info

Control ownership of objects written to this bucket from other AWS accounts and the use of access control lists (ACLs). Object ownership determines who can specify access to objects.

Object Ownership

- ACLs disabled (recommended) — All objects in this bucket are owned by this account. Access to this bucket and its objects is specified using only policies.
- ACLs enabled — Objects in this bucket can be owned by other AWS accounts. Access to this bucket and its objects can be specified using ACLs.

Object Ownership

Bucket owner enforced

Block Public Access settings for this bucket

Public access is granted to buckets and objects through access control lists (ACLs), bucket policies, access point policies, or all. In order to ensure that public access to this bucket and its objects is blocked, turn on Block all public access. These settings apply only to this bucket and its access points. AWS recommends that you turn on Block all public access, but before applying any of these settings, ensure that your applications will work correctly without public access. If you require some level of public access to this bucket or objects within, you can customize the individual settings below to suit your specific storage use cases. Learn more

☑ **Block *all* public access**

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us-east-1.console.aws.amazon.com/s3/buckets?region=us-east-1

Finish update

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Amazon S3 > Buckets

Successfully created bucket "live-doc-for-team"
To upload files and folders, or to configure additional bucket settings, choose **View details**.

View details

General purpose buckets All AWS Regions | Directory buckets

General purpose buckets (2) Info

Copy ARN | Empty | Delete | Create bucket

Buckets are containers for data stored in S3.

Find buckets by name

Name	AWS Region	Creation date
live-doc-for-team	US East (N. Virginia) us-east-1	December 9, 2025, 18:30:19 (UTC+00:00)
livedoc-s3-09	US East (N. Virginia) us-east-1	December 9, 2025, 17:53:56 (UTC+00:00)

Account snapshot Info

View dashboard

Updated daily

Storage Lens provides visibility into storage usage and activity trends.

External access summary - *new* Info

Updated daily

External access findings help you identify bucket permissions that allow public access or access from other AWS accounts.

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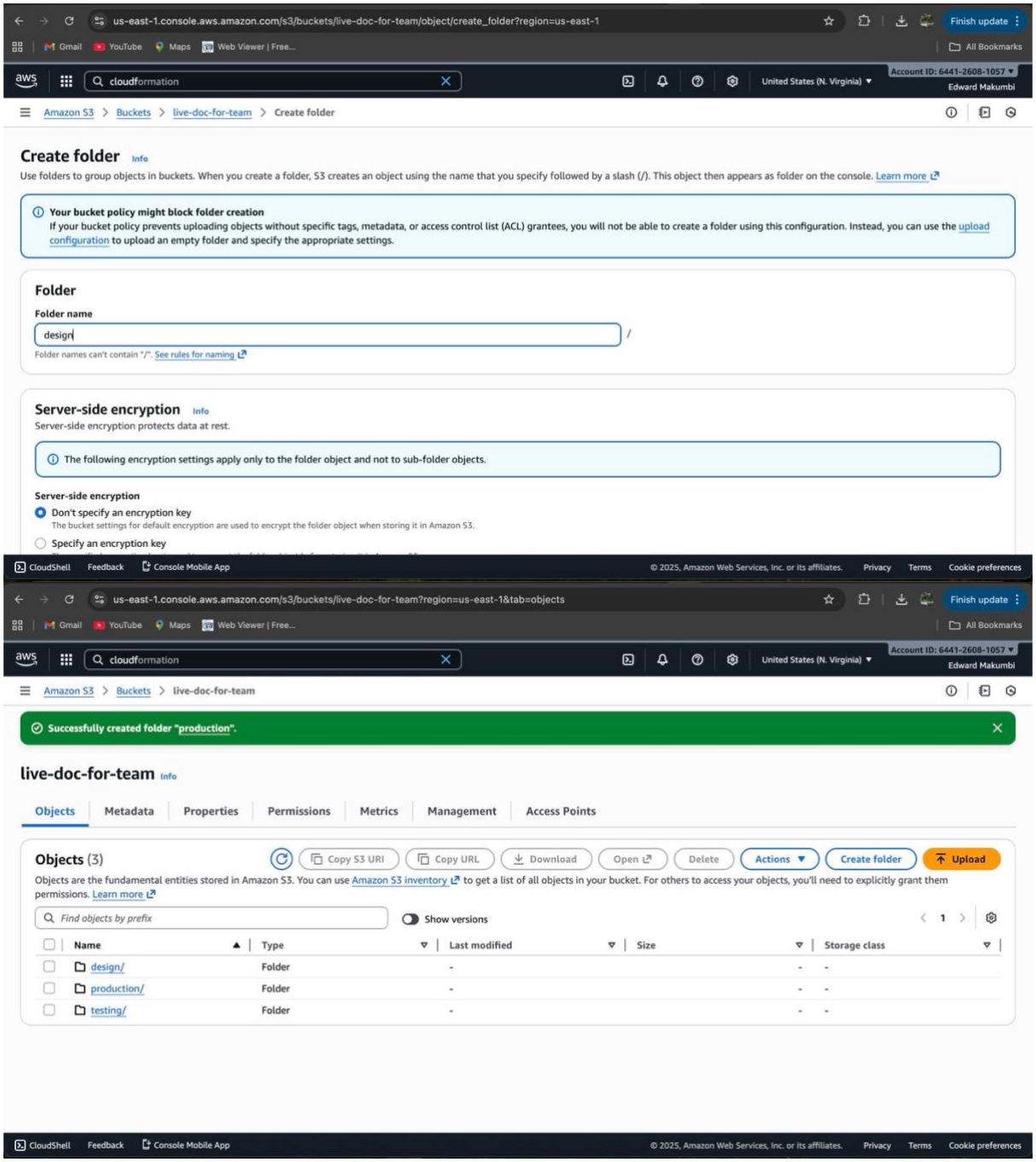

For governance and billing

AWS organisations was used, where IAM roles are managed and the hierarchy of the organisation

Billing and cost management was used to monitor and manage costs and budgets.

us-east-1.console.aws.amazon.com/organizations/v2/home/organizations/create

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AWS Organizations > Creating an organization

AWS Organizations

Invitations

Creating an organization

Upgrading your account to pay-as-you-go-pricing
Creating an organization automatically upgrades your account from a free plan to a paid plan with pay-as-you-go pricing. Learn more

Consideration for the management account

- This account will become the management account of your organization
- We recommend to use an account with no resources or workloads
- The management account can't be changed after creating an organization

Learn more

Cancel Create an organization

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us-east-1.console.aws.amazon.com/costmanagement/home?region=us-east-1#/home

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Billing and Cost Management

Billing View New

Home
Getting Started
Dashboards New
Billing and Payments
Bills
Payments
Credits
Purchase Orders
Cost and Usage Analysis
Cost Explorer
Cost Explorer Saved Reports
Cost Anomaly Detection
Free Tier
Data Exports
Customer Carbon Footprint Tool

Billing and Cost Management home Info

Provide feedback Need help? Ask Q Reset layout

Cost summary Info

Month-to-date cost
$0.51
↑ 112% compared to last month for same period

Last month's cost for same time period
$0.24
Nov 1 – 9

Total forecasted cost for current month
$1.66
↑ 37% compared to last month's total costs

Last month's total cost
$1.21

View bill

Cost monitor Info

Budgets status
OK
1 active budget(s)

Cost anomalies status (MTD)
None detected
1 monitor(s) active

Cost breakdown Info

Group costs by
Service

Costs (USD)
4.00

Recommended actions (4) Info

Review anomalies
1 cost anomalies detected in the last 90 days with a total cost impact of $0.08.
View cost anomalies

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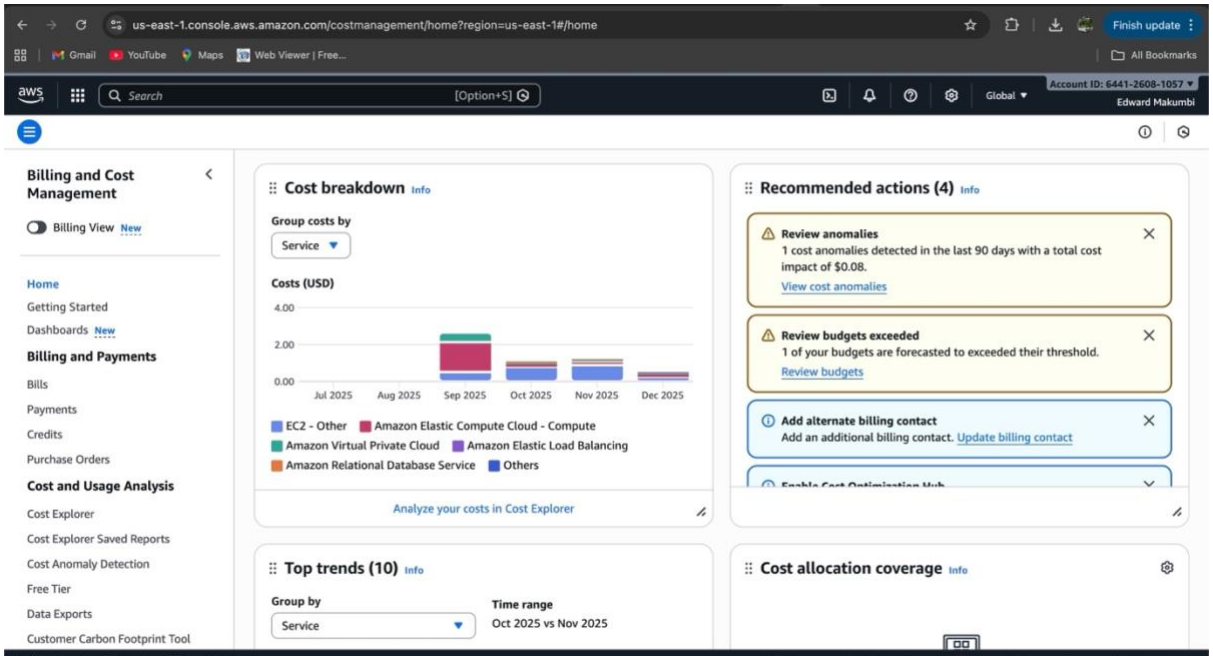

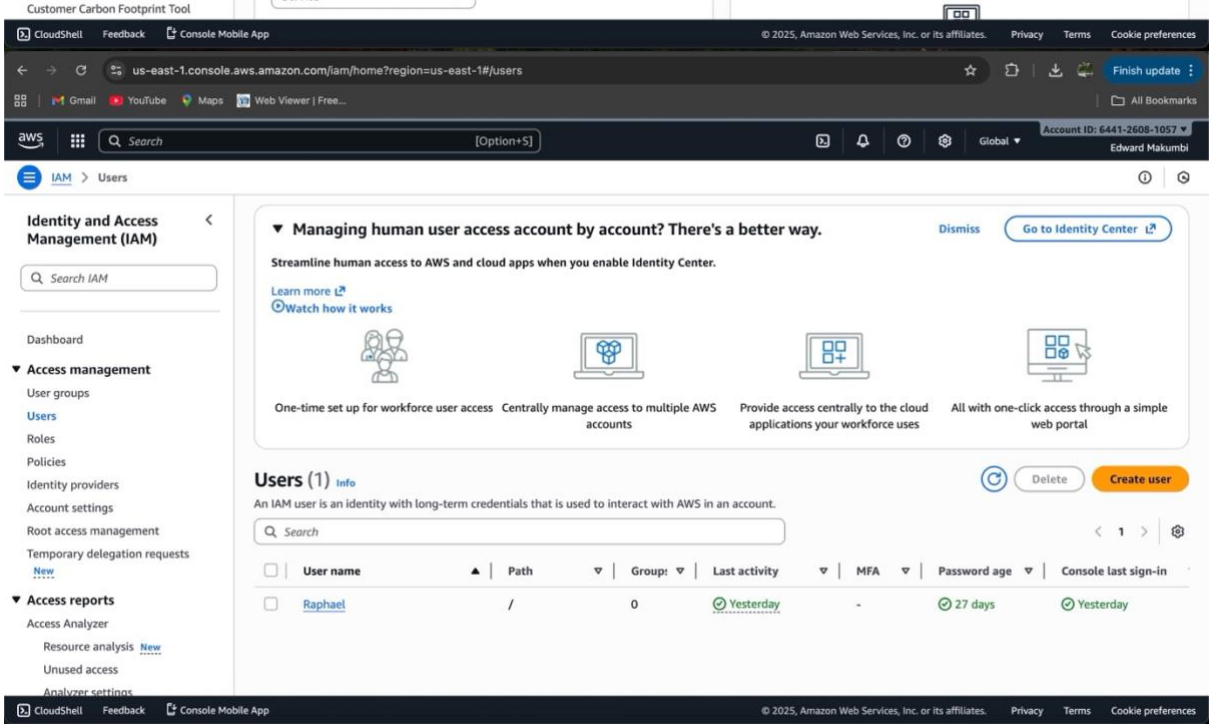

The Autoscaling group livedoc-ASG and the load balancer live-doc-LB were created to handle increasing and variable traffic load, an Auto Scaling Group (ASG) had multiple EC2 instances- min 2 and max 5

us-east-1.console.aws.amazon.com/ec2/home?region=us-east-1#CreateCLBWizard:

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aws | s3 | United States (N. Virginia) | Account ID: 6441-2608-1057 | Edward Makumbi

EC2 > Load balancers > Create Classic Load Balancer

Create Classic Load Balancer Info

The Classic Load Balancer distributes incoming application traffic across multiple EC2 instance targets in multiple Availability Zones. This increases the fault tolerance of your applications. Elastic Load Balancing detects unhealthy instances and routes traffic only to healthy instances.

▶ How Classic Load Balancers work

Basic configuration

Load balancer name

Name must be unique within your AWS account and can't be changed after the load balancer is created.

A maximum of 32 alphanumeric characters including hyphens are allowed, but the name must not begin or end with a hyphen.

Scheme | Info

Scheme can't be changed after the load balancer is created.

- Internet-facing
  - Serves internet-facing traffic.
  - Has public IP addresses.
  - DNS name resolves to public IPs.
  - Requires a public subnet.
- Internal
  - Serves internal traffic.
  - Has private IP addresses.
  - DNS name resolves to private IPs.

Network mapping Info

The load balancer routes traffic to targets in the selected subnets, and in accordance with your network settings.

us-east-1.console.aws.amazon.com/ec2/home?region=us-east-1#CreateAutoScalingGroup:

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aws | s3 | United States (N. Virginia) | Account ID: 6441-2608-1057 | Edward Makumbi

EC2 > Auto Scaling groups > Create Auto Scaling group

- Step 1 — Choose launch template
- Step 2 — Choose instance launch options
- Step 3 - *optional* — Integrate with other services
- Step 4 - *optional* — Configure group size and scaling
- Step 5 - *optional* — Add notifications
- Step 6 - *optional* — Add tags
- Step 7 — Review

Choose launch template Info

Specify a launch template that contains settings common to all EC2 instances that are launched by this Auto Scaling group.

Name

Auto Scaling group name

Enter a name to identify the group.

live-doc-ASG

Must be unique to this account in the current Region and no more than 255 characters.

Launch template Info

For accounts created after May 31, 2023, the EC2 console only supports creating Auto Scaling groups with launch templates. Creating Auto Scaling groups with launch configurations is not recommended but still available via the CLI and API until December 31, 2023.

Launch template

Choose a launch template that contains the instance-level settings, such as the Amazon Machine Image (AMI), instance type, key pair, and security groups.

Live-doc-server-template

Create a launch template

Version

Default (1)

Create a launch template version

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EC2 > Auto Scaling groups > Create Auto Scaling group

Step 7
Review

Select the load balancers to attach

- Choose from your load balancer target groups
  This option allows you to attach Application, Network, or Gateway Load Balancers.
- Choose from Classic Load Balancers

Classic Load Balancers

Select Classic Load Balancers

live-doc-LB
Classic Load Balancer

VPC Lattice integration options Info

To improve networking capabilities and scalability, integrate your Auto Scaling group with VPC Lattice. VPC Lattice facilitates communications between AWS services and helps you connect and manage your applications across compute services in AWS.

Select VPC Lattice service to attach

- No VPC Lattice service
  VPC Lattice will not manage your Auto Scaling group's network access and connectivity with other services.
- Attach to VPC Lattice service
  Incoming requests associated with specified VPC Lattice target groups will be routed to your Auto Scaling group.

Create new VPC Lattice service

Application Recovery Controller (ARC) zonal shift - *new* Info

During an Availability Zone impairment, target instance launches towards other healthy Availability Zones.

Enable zonal shift

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EC2 > Auto Scaling groups > Create Auto Scaling group

Choose launch template

Step 2
Choose instance launch options

Step 3 - *optional*
Integrate with other services

Step 4 - *optional*
Configure group size and scaling

Step 5 - *optional*
Add notifications

Step 6 - *optional*
Add tags

Step 7
Review

Configure group size and scaling - *optional* Info

Define your group's desired capacity and scaling limits. You can optionally add automatic scaling to adjust the size of your group.

Group size Info

Set the initial size of the Auto Scaling group. After creating the group, you can change its size to meet demand, either manually or by using automatic scaling.

Desired capacity type

Choose the unit of measurement for the desired capacity value. vCPUs and Memory(GiB) are only supported for mixed instances groups configured with a set of instance attributes.

Units (number of instances)

Desired capacity

Specify your group size.

4

Scaling Info

You can resize your Auto Scaling group manually or automatically to meet changes in demand.

Scaling limits

Set limits on how much your desired capacity can be increased or decreased.

Min desired capacity	Max desired capacity
2	5
Equal or less than desired capacity	Equal or greater than desired capacity

Automatic scaling - *optional*

Choose whether to use a target tracking policy Info

You can set up other metric-based scaling policies and scheduled scaling after creating your Auto Scaling group.

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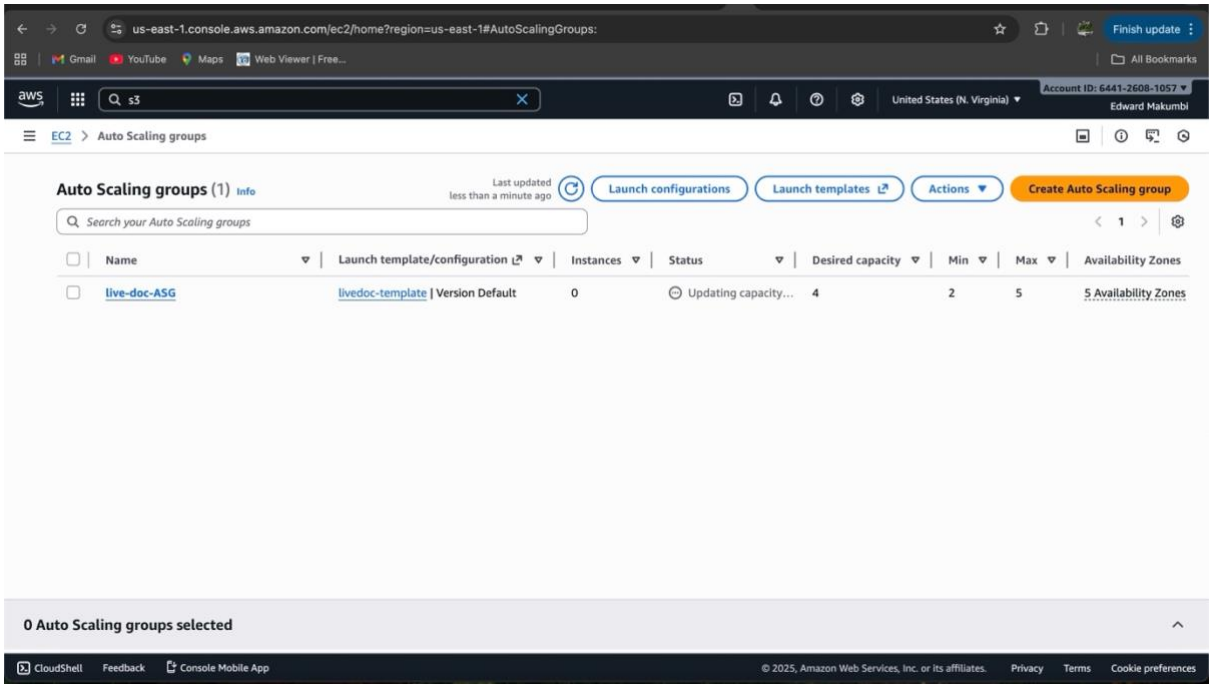
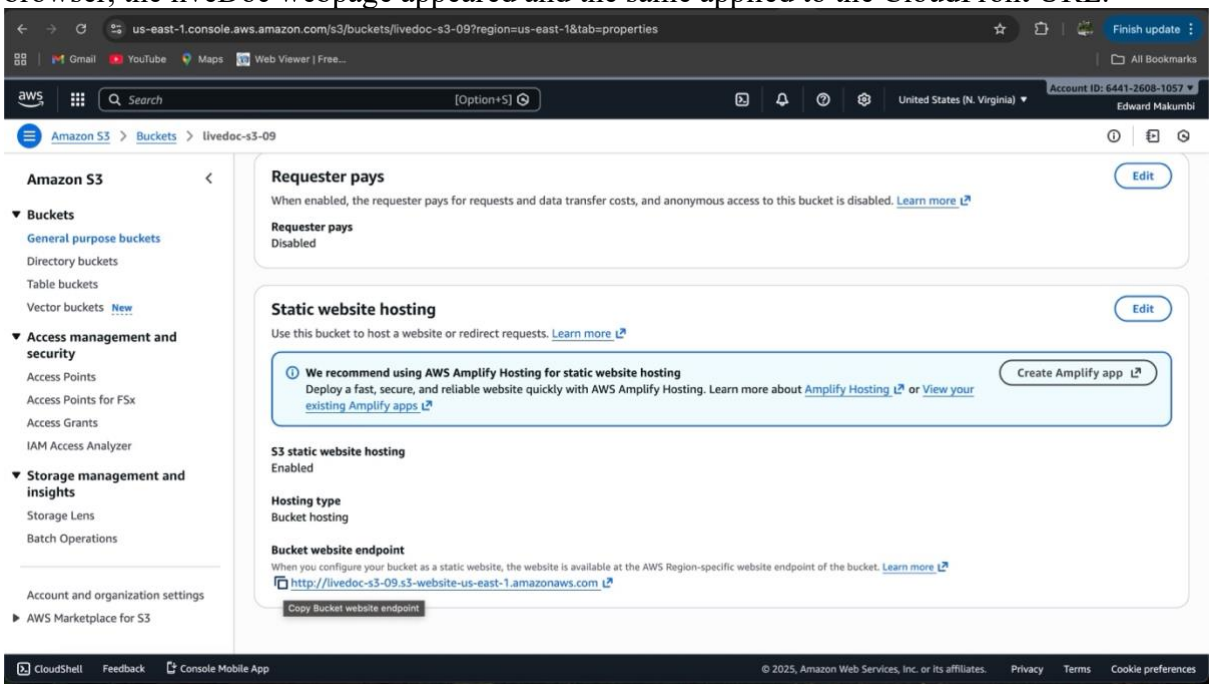


Testing

On copying the URL of the s3 bucket hosting the static website and pasting it into the browser, the liveDoc webpage appeared and the same applied to the CloudFront URL.



Not Secure livedoc-s3-09.s3-website-us-east-1.amazonaws.com

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us-east-1.console.aws.amazon.com/cloudfront/v4/home?region=us-east-1#/distributions/E2MC0XR9JSHLSE

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aws ec2 Global Account ID: 6441-2608-1057 Edward Makumbi

CloudFront > Distributions > E2MC0XR9JSHLSE

Live-doc-CDN Standard

View metrics

Distribution domain name copied

Distribution domain name
dhn5z9q2p3ud9.cloudfront.net

Billing
Pay-as-you-go
Switch to a plan

ARN
arn:aws:cloudfront::644126081057:distribution/E2MC0XR9JSHLSE

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- No overage charges.
- Blocked requests and DDoS attacks never count against your usage allowance.
- Data transfer costs from your AWS origins (such as Amazon S3, Application Load Balancer, or API Gateway) to CloudFront are automatically waived.

General | Security | Origins | Behaviors | Error pages | Invalidations | Logging | Tags

Settings

Edit

Name
Live-doc-CDN

Description

Alternate domain names
-
Add domain

Standard logging
Off

Cookie logging
Off

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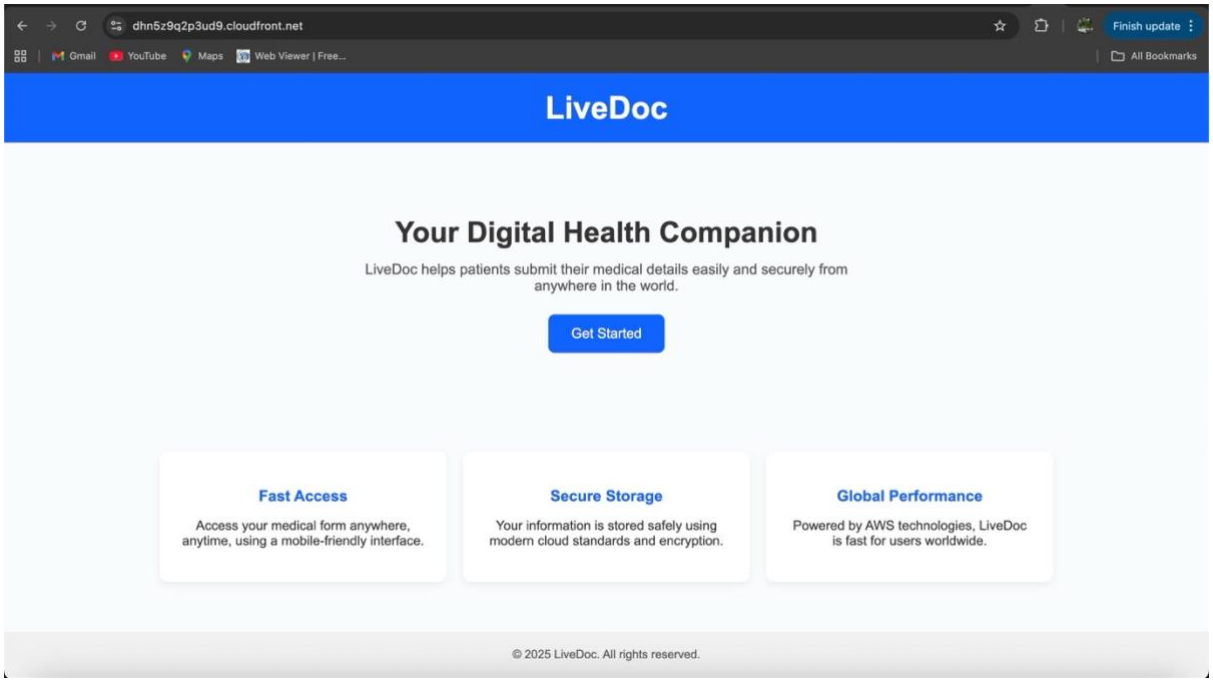
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